Installation Guide

Set up the three tools used in this course:

#	Tool	What it is	Where it runs
1	**Claude Code in the terminal**	The full agentic coding tool, driven from a command line	Your terminal
2	**Claude Code in VS Code**	The same Claude Code, inside the editor	VS Code extension
3	**Claude Cowork**	Claude working on files and tasks you delegate, not just chat	Claude Desktop app

You can install them in any order. Do **1** first if you are unsure, because the other two lean on the same sign-in.

> Commands below are for **Windows** first (PowerShell), with macOS, Linux and WSL alongside. Install steps change over time, so if a command fails, check the official docs at `docs.claude.com` for the current one.

1. Claude Code in the terminal

Install

Pick **one** method.

Windows, PowerShell (recommended)

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Windows, Command Prompt (CMD)

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.cmd -o install.cmd && install.cmd && del
install.cmd
```

Windows, winget

```
winget install Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

macOS, Linux or WSL

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

macOS, Homebrew

```
brew install --cask claude-code
```

> **Updates:** the script installers (PowerShell, CMD, `curl`) update themselves in the background. **winget and Homebrew do not**, so run `winget upgrade Anthropic.ClaudeCode` or `brew upgrade claude-code` yourself.

Verify

Close the terminal and open a **new** one (the installer changes your `PATH`), then:

```
claude --version
```

You should see a version number. If you get "command not found", see Troubleshooting.

First run and sign-in

```
cd path/to/your/project
claude
```

1. Choose a colour theme.
2. Choose how to sign in:
   - **Claude account** (Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise): a browser tab opens, you approve, and you return to the terminal. If your organization has an Enterprise account, choose that option.
   - **Anthropic Console (API key)**: billed per token.
3. Confirm you trust the folder when asked.

Claude can read and edit **the folder you start it in and everything below it**, so start it in the project you mean to work on, not in your home directory.

Try it

```
> what files are in this folder?
```

Useful first commands: `/help` (list commands), `/status` (who you are signed in as), `/clear` (start a fresh conversation), `/exit` (quit).

Health check

```
claude doctor
```

Reports the install type, version and common configuration problems.

2. Claude Code in VS Code

Install

1. Install VS Code if you do not have it.
2. Open the **Extensions** panel (`Ctrl+Shift+X`, or `Cmd+Shift+X` on Mac).
3. Search for **Claude Code**.
4. Choose the one published by **Anthropic** (look for the verified blue check) and click **Install**.
5. Restart VS Code if it asks.

Open it

- Click the **Claude logo** in the sidebar or editor toolbar, **or**
- Open the Command Palette (`Ctrl+Shift+P`) and run **Claude Code: Open in New Tab**.

Sign in the first time, the same way as in the terminal.

What you get

- A chat panel next to your code that works on the folder you opened in VS Code
- Diffs shown in the editor before you accept a change
- The files you have open or selected are shared with Claude as context

It is the same Claude Code as the terminal, with a nicer view of the edits. Features usually reach the terminal first. If you prefer the terminal experience inside the editor, you can also open VS Code's integrated terminal (`Ctrl+``) and run `claude` there. For that, install the terminal version (section 1) as well.

Verify

1. Open a project folder with **File > Open Folder**.
2. Open Claude Code and ask: `what does this project do?`
3. You should get an answer that refers to your files.

3. Claude Cowork

Cowork is a mode inside the **Claude Desktop** app. It is not a separate download.

Install

1. Download Claude Desktop from `claude.com/download` (Windows or Mac).
2. Run the installer and open the app.
3. **Sign in** with your Claude account.
4. Find **Cowork** in the mode selector at the top right (next to Chat and Code).

If you cannot see Cowork, check two things: you may need a **paid plan**, and you may need to **update the desktop app** to the latest version.

Point it at a folder

1. In the prompt bar, click **Work in a project** and pick a folder.
2. Choose a folder for **one project**, not your whole Documents folder.

Cowork gets **read and write** access to that folder. It can open, edit and create files there, and it saves finished work back into it.

Optional: connectors

Open **Customize** to connect the apps your work lives in (Gmail, Google Drive, Slack, a calendar, and so on). Set up one at first, and switch them on or off per task.

Permissions

Mode	What happens
Ask before acting (default)	Claude pauses for your approval before actions that reach outside, such as sending an email or sharing a file
Act without asking	No pause for those actions. Use only for tools and tasks you trust

In both modes Claude **always asks before permanently deleting a file**, and you cannot skip that.

Verify

Pick a small folder and ask:

```
Take a look at everything in this folder and write me a brief on what you found.
```

If you get a summary and Claude can open the files, it works. Practise on a **copy** of real material first, not your only copy.

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4. Git

Git tracks every change to your files, so you can always see what Claude changed and roll it back. Claude Code can also run Git for you (commits, branches, pull requests). On native Windows, Claude Code needs **Git for Windows** to be installed.

Install

Windows (recommended)

Download the installer from git-scm.com/download/win and run it. The default options are fine.

Or with winget:

```
winget install --id Git.Git -e
```

macOS

```
xcode-select --install
```

Or with Homebrew: `brew install git`

Linux or WSL

```
sudo apt install git
```

Verify

Close the terminal and open a **new** one, then:

```
git --version
```

You should see a version number.

One-time setup

Tell Git who you are. These details appear on every commit you make.

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "you@example.com"
git config --global init.defaultBranch main
```

Check what you set:

```
git config --global --list
```
